



TWELVE-MONTH PROGRESS REPORT

Gambia: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-17

Edition of 2026-08-18 · 67 systems and instruments tracked, 13 of them not held

Compiled 2026-08-17 from the Data Landscapers source base. Sections follow the status report. Each opens with a movement ledger comparing the position at the start and end of the period, which runs to the date of issue rather than to the last month's close.

Of 67 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 29 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-17, 17 did not, 8 carry no stated baseline, and 13 are **Not held** at both ends.

Shape check, run before the comparison: 61 sources for this place in the window — 27 in the earlier half (2025-08 to 2026-02), 34 in the later (2026-03 to 2026-08). The two halves are comparable, so the comparison is made over the whole window.

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Summary of the period

At the start of this period The Gambia had no data centre of any kind, produced identity cards under a foreign concession, had no comprehensive data-protection law and no instant payment rail. Twelve months later it has [two data centres](#), a [state-run identity system](#), an [enacted statute](#) and a [live payment switch](#) — four foundational pieces, all delivered inside one year.

What did not move is as consistent. Every register that was already running stayed exactly where it was: the civil registration figure and the social registry coverage figure are the same at both ends of the window, and no operating figure has been published for any of the four new systems. Two announced arrangements produced nothing at all — the [blockchain platform of January 2025](#) and the [transport fare partnership of June 2025](#) — and the [Starlink licence](#) is refused at the end of the period as it was withheld at the start.

Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
GAMTEL national broadband modernisation PPP	Did not exist	US\$50m partnership signed to take the national backbone from 40 Gbps to 800 Gbps; no completion date, milestone schedule or dalasi figure published (2026-01)	ADVANCED
Gambia National Broadband Network (China Eximbank loan)	In service under a US\$25.9m concessional loan repayable by GAMTEL, with a servicing history of arrears (2017 loan)	Unchanged on the record; no statement of network condition, utilisation or debt position since 2020	NO CHANGE
Liberia-Gambia-Sierra Leone roaming agreement	Signed; no tariff, traffic or commencement figure published (2025-08)	Unchanged; no tariff, traffic or commencement figure published (2026-08)	NO CHANGE
Starlink satellite service licence	Fee paid and licence unissued for over a year, the government citing due diligence in the face of United States pressure (2025-07)	Still unlicensed; the minister states Starlink lacks the competencies and equipment for a VSAT permit and requires a general satellite licence instead (2026-05)	NO CHANGE

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
National Data Centre, Abuko	Did not exist	State facility in service hosting the national identity management system; no capacity, tier rating or operating cost published (2026-07)	ADVANCED
QGroup House data centre	Did not exist; no data centre of any kind on record	First private data centre in service, built by QGroup and QCell with Huawei as long-term vendor (2026-04)	ADVANCED

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
National cybersecurity agency or incident response team	No position held at the start of the window	An institutional design on paper: GM-CSIRT operating a national Cybersecurity Centre with a security operations centre inside it, a National Cybersecurity Coordination Directorate, a National Cybersecurity Commission, an advisory board, sectoral focal points and sector CSIRTs, and a police cybercrime response unit. The plan directs that GM-CSIRT be operationalised and strengthened in budget and technology; nothing held states that any of these bodies is standing	BASELINE NOT HELD

Hosting went from nothing to two facilities. [QGroup House](#) opened on 30 April 2026 and the state's [National Data Centre](#) on 1 July 2026. That is the single largest change in the country's digital estate in the period, and neither facility has published a capacity figure, a tier rating or an operating cost.

The backbone acquired a contract rather than capacity. The [US\\$50m partnership announced on 5 January 2026](#) commits to raising national capacity from 40 Gbps to 800 Gbps, and no milestone under it has been reported since. The earlier network built on Chinese concessional lending has produced no statement of condition or debt position at either end of the window.

Satellite access is where the period's clearest non-movement sits. At the start the licence had been paid for and not issued; at the end the [minister has stated the ground for refusing it](#) – the wrong licence category – which is a more explicit position, not a different one.

Digital public infrastructure

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Gambia-Senegal customs data exchange roadmap	Did not exist	Agreed to install the GAINDE customs system at Karang, Keur Ayib and Selety within three months, deploy SIGMAT transit tracking, exchange customs data by interface once GAINDE is live, replace transit agents with a Single Administrative Document and reactivate the EnCen intelligence platform (2026-07)	ADVANCED
National Enterprise Architecture	Did not exist	Validated as the interoperability blueprint for citizen-centric services; not adopted, funded or implemented on the record (2026-05)	ADVANCED

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Margins ID national identity contract	Did not exist; the standing arrangement was the concession the 2025 State of the Nation address set out to replace (2025-08)	Eight-year design-build-finance-operate-transfer contract in force, with a 70/30 revenue share, ten-year card validity, free replacement of valid cards and a phase-2 data centre (2026-01)	ADVANCED
National Identity Management System (GAM ID)	Did not exist; identity cards were produced under a foreign concession the government had resolved to replace (2025-08)	Live and issuing instant GAM ID cards from the National Data Centre, with nationwide enrolment opening 4 August 2026 (2026-07)	ADVANCED

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
BANTABA 2.0 instant payment system	Did not exist	First inclusive instant payment system in service, built on Mojaloop and operated by GamSwitch across banks, mobile money, microfinance institutions and fintechs; no transaction volume published (2025-12)	ADVANCED
SUTURA government revenue collection integration	Did not exist	Memorandum signed to wire a domestically built platform, distributed through GAMPOST, into government revenue collection; no go-live date, volume, fee structure or list of connected banks published, and no text of the memorandum is held (2026-07)	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Yonna Wallet government payment collection	Did not exist	Collecting identity card, passport and business-registration fees, with diaspora payment through the Yonna Global Wallet and auto-generated receipts; no volume or fee structure published (2026-03)	ADVANCED
Wave-GTSC public transport fare payment	Partnership signed; no deployment, route or volume figure published (2025-08)	Unchanged; no deployment, route or volume figure published (2026-08)	NO CHANGE
UNDP-FreedomPay Wallet blockchain payment distribution pilot	BASELINE NOT HELD	UNDP working with FreedomPay Wallet in The Gambia on transparent digital payment distribution, grouped with pilots in Haiti, Syria, Kenya and Guatemala; no country-specific volume, beneficiary count or launch date for The Gambia is published	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Electronic civil registration and vital statistics	In service as the interoperability backbone, about 1.17m people registered with a unique national identification number (2024-03)	Unchanged; the June 2025 commitment to integrate it with identity cards and the passport has produced no published integration milestone (2026-08)	NO CHANGE
Gambia Social Registry	203,022 households, about 70% of the population, carrying the Nafa cash transfers (2024-04)	Unchanged; no coverage update published since (2026-08)	NO CHANGE

Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
DHIS2 for Education	BASELINE NOT HELD	Individual learner tracking and school report cards being built on DHIS2 by the basic and secondary education ministry; no coverage figure or go-live date published (2026-05)	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Smart Paper Technology for community health data	BASELINE NOT HELD	In use for community health data capture; no district count or record volume published (2025-12)	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Digital Single Window Business Registration System	Did not exist	Being finalised, with over 350 agricultural enterprises digitally mapped inside a programme reaching more than 4,050 firms; no launch date published (2026-08)	ADVANCED
Digitalisation of police records	Did not exist	Directed by the Inspector General; no system, vendor, budget or timetable published (2026-03)	ADVANCED
Election digitalisation for the December 2026 polls	Did not exist	Polling-station mapping, results transmission and tablets announced for the December 2026 elections; no procurement, test or audit arrangement published (2026-03)	ADVANCED
Integrated Tax Administration System	Did not exist	Planned for electronic filing; no procurement, vendor, timetable or budget line published (2026-07)	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
National Digital Addressing rollout	No standing body; the Digital Addressing Policy dates from 2023 (2025-08)	Steering committee launched; no national coverage figure or rollout milestone published (2025-10)	ADVANCED
Digital excise tax stamp	In operation, implemented by SICPA Gambia; the authority's own figures put excise collections at D48.47m for January to August 2024 against D6.31m in the same months of 2023 (2025-08)	In operation and studied by revenue administrations from Nigeria, Senegal, Sierra Leone, South Africa and Rwanda; the authority claims a 95% reduction in smuggling of excisable goods, with no method and no independent verification (2026-07)	NO CHANGE
GRA digital tax invoicing	In service with tamper-proof digital signatures; no coverage or yield figure published (2025-08)	Named in the finance ministry's account of the reform stack; still no separate coverage or yield figure (2026-07)	NO CHANGE
Integrated Financial Management Information System	In service across ministries with revenue and treasury interfaces (2020)	Unchanged; no statement of coverage or condition since the project closed (2026-08)	NO CHANGE
Community policing case management and facility mapping	BASELINE NOT HELD	Mobile case-management applications and geographic facility mapping in use under a United Nations Development Programme-backed community policing programme; no case volume published (2026-03)	Baseline not held

Digitalisation of sub-national government

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Kanifing municipal digital addressing	BASELINE NOT HELD	36,000 properties georeferenced, feeding property-tax billing and waste management in Kanifing Municipality (2025-12)	Baseline not held

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Coordination of official statistics production	No convened process on record	Producers and users convened by the Central Bank with the International Monetary Fund and the Bureau of Statistics, naming data gaps, inconsistency and inaccessibility as the constraints; no framework or workplan published (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Gambia Labour Force Survey series	Four rounds published, with no cross-round comparison volume (2025-08)	Fifth round published with the first systematic comparison across the 2023, 2025 and 2026 rounds, and a sixth round confirmed for later in 2026 (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Labour force participation rate	43.6% (2023 Q1)	54.5% (2026 Q1)	ADVANCED
Unemployment rate	7.6% (2023 Q1)	6.2% (2026 Q1)	ADVANCED
Agriculture share of employment	Not comparable; earlier rounds counted own-use food production	17.8% (2026 Q1)	BASELINE NOT HELD

Identity moved twice in twelve months: from a concession to a [signed contract in January 2026](#), and from a contract to a [live system on 1 July 2026](#). Both ends of the underlying register, however, are the same figure: the civil registration system stands at about 1.17m people at the start and the end of the period, and the [social registry at 203,022 households](#) at both. The registers on which the new system depends have published nothing since 2024.

Payments gained three channels and no numbers. The [switch went live in December 2025](#), [Yonna Wallet in March 2026](#) and [SUTURA by memorandum in July 2026](#). None has published a transaction volume, and the [2025 transport fare partnership](#) has produced no deployment at all.

Revenue systems held their position while the claims about them grew. The digital excise stamp is in operation at both ends; what changed is the [set of administrations coming to study it](#) and the addition of a 95% smuggling-reduction claim carrying no method. That is a change in the system's reputation, not in its measured performance, and the two are worth keeping apart.

Statistics show the clearest measured movement in the ledger. Labour force participation moved from [43.6% in the 2023 round to 54.5% in 2026](#) and unemployment from 7.6% to 6.2%, and the [comparison volume that establishes both is itself new](#). The agriculture share cannot be compared across the window at all: the producer changed the standard.

Governance and regulation

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Communications Bill 2025	Not introduced; first reading followed on 19 November 2025 (2025-08)	Passed second reading and referred to committee, with the Press Union pressing for repeal of the restrictive media laws around it (2026-07)	ADVANCED
State Intelligence Service Bill	Did not exist	Draft validated, reported to require judicial warrants and oversight for intrusive measures and to give the Assembly review of the Service's budgets and operations; not tabled (2026-07)	ADVANCED

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
National Cybersecurity Strategy and Action Plan 2022-2026	In force, on a period running to 2026 (2025-08)	Unchanged; no successor, mid-term review or implementation report is held, and the plan runs out at the end of 2026 (2026-08)	NO CHANGE
National Data Policy 2025	Draft, not adopted (2025-08)	Still a draft; no adoption, gazetting or implementation instrument is held (2026-08)	NO CHANGE
National Digital Economy Master Plan 2024-2034	In force as the framing instrument for the digital programme (2025-08)	Unchanged; no mid-term review, monitoring report or costed implementation plan is held (2026-08)	NO CHANGE
National Digital Identity Strategy 2023-2028	In force, with the identity system it provides for not yet built (2025-08)	In force and now carrying a delivered identity system (2026-07)	NO CHANGE

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
ATAF Heads of Tax Administrations Master Class	Did not exist as a Gambian commitment	Convened by the Gambia Revenue Authority, with the Forum's executive secretary arguing that digital systems deliver only alongside governance reform and pressing for a united African position in the United Nations tax convention negotiations (2026-07)	ADVANCED
Senegal-Gambia regulatory cooperation and free roaming agreement	Did not exist	Signed, covering telecommunications regulatory cooperation and free roaming; no commencement date or tariff published (2026-06)	ADVANCED

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Personal Data Protection and Privacy Act 2025	No comprehensive data-protection law; the Bill was before the National Assembly (2025-08)	Enacted, with extraterritorial scope, seven lawful bases, a sensitive-data regime covering genetic, biometric and health data, and rights of access, rectification, erasure and protection from solely automated decisions (2025-12)	ADVANCED

The statute book moved and the policy shelf did not. The Gambia had no comprehensive data-protection law when this period opened; the [Personal Data Protection and Privacy Act](#) was enacted by December 2025, ending a process that had stalled for several years. The [Communications Bill](#) went from not introduced to sitting with committees after a second reading in March 2026, and a [State Intelligence Service Bill](#) that did not exist at the start of the window was validated on 31 July 2026.

Against that, the [National Data Policy 2025](#) is a draft at both ends and the [Master Plan 2024-2034](#) has produced no review or costed plan in twelve months. The one instrument whose position improved without moving is the identity strategy: unchanged as a document, but now carrying a delivered system rather than an intention.

The regional layer is new. The [agreement with Senegal](#) on regulatory cooperation and free roaming did not exist a year ago, and neither did the country's [hosting of the continent's tax administrators](#).

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
GAMCEL 80% share sale and network modernisation	Sale of 80% of GAMCEL announced to lawmakers at a winning bid of D6.7bn, no agreement signed (2025-12)	Agreement signed transferring an 80% equity stake to YCELL against a GMD 6.1bn modernisation programme covering 4G and 5G radio access, core, operations and billing systems, hybrid tower power and revenue assurance (2026-07)	ADVANCED

Innovation ecosystem

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Kalp Foundation Gambia One blockchain platform	Memorandum signed; nothing on record being built (2025-08)	Unchanged; no build, pilot, funding or withdrawal reported in the nineteen months since (2026-08)	NO CHANGE
Gambia Digital Innovation Sprint	BASELINE NOT HELD	Held with the National Youth Council, the communications ministry and UNICEF; no follow-on funding or incubation route published (2026-07)	Baseline not held

The state's exit from mobile ownership is the sector's one movement. At the start of the period the sale of GAMCEL had been [announced to lawmakers at a D6.7 billion winning bid with no agreement signed](#); at the end an [80% stake has transferred against a GMD 6.1 billion modernisation commitment](#). No post-transaction financial position for either operator has been published.

Set against it, the [blockchain platform agreed in January 2025](#) is at the same position at both ends of the window: a memorandum, with no build, pilot, funding or withdrawal reported in nineteen months.

On artificial intelligence there is nothing to compare. The base carried no Gambian position at the start of the period and carries none now.

Inclusion and capacity

Literacy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Rural women and girls digital rights programme	Did not exist	400 women and girls trained across four regions, with 40 community broadcasters and 80 peer mentors; the implementer names unreliable internet, high data costs and unreliable electricity as the obstacles to continued practice (2026-07)	ADVANCED

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
National Labour Digital Skill programme	Did not exist	Methodology validated against a target of 280 certified, funded at US\$3.35m through the regional digital integration programme; no completion figure published (2025-12)	ADVANCED

Two programmes arrived where nothing existed: a [digital skills methodology validated in December 2025](#) against a target of 280 certified, and a [rural digital rights programme that reached 400 women and girls across four regions](#).

Finance

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
AfDB digital government project	Pipeline (2025-08)	Still pipeline; no approval, signature or first disbursement is held (2026-08)	NO CHANGE
Gates Foundation payment system pilot	Closed (2025-08)	Closed; no evaluation or successor operation is held (2026-08)	NO CHANGE
WARDIP national allocation	In implementation; no disbursement or results figure published (2025-08)	Unchanged; no disbursement, results framework or mid-term review is held (2026-08)	NO CHANGE

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-17	MOVEMENT
Tax-to-GDP ratio	9% (2022)	13% (2025)	ADVANCED
Total tax collected	D11bn (2022)	D25bn (2025), against a D27.5bn target for 2026	ADVANCED

The clearest movement in the state's own account of the period is fiscal. Total tax collected went from **D11bn in 2022 to D25bn in 2025** and the **ratio of tax to GDP from 9% to 13%**; both series were published within this window rather than accruing across it, and both are the collecting side's own account of its performance.

External financing did not move at all. The **World Bank's regional programme allocation** has published no disbursement or results figure at either end of the period, the **African Development Bank's digital government project is pipeline at both ends**, and the **Gates Foundation's payment pilot was closed before the window opened** and has produced no evaluation since.

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Power supply to the national digital estate	A generation, tariff or outage statement bearing on data-centre or network operation, or the power provision in either data centre's design.	not yet probed
Domestic technical capacity to operate the national digital systems	A staffing plan, skills audit or operations report covering who runs the National Data Centre, the identity system and the payment switch.	not yet probed
Rural digital data capture	An agricultural, land or extension data-collection programme, or a rural administration digital plan. The health and social registry systems are the only field data capture on record.	not yet probed
Data Protection and Privacy Commission	A commencement instrument, an appointment notice, a budget line or a first annual report. The Act provides for an independent Commission; nothing held states whether it has been constituted.	2026-08-09
Legal basis for issuing identity cards outside the country	An official response, a regulation or a registry statement covering issuance in Mauritania, Congo and Togo, which the opposition alleged was unlawful in August 2025.	not yet probed
National open-data portal	A published portal, dataset catalogue, or the text of the Open Data Strategy 2023-2026 the base refers to but does not hold.	not yet probed
Public participation in digital policymaking	A consultation register, a published submission round, or a civil-society account of participation in the data, communications or intelligence bills.	not yet probed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
European Union digital cooperation with The Gambia	A Global Gateway announcement, an EU delegation programme document, or a financing agreement naming The Gambia.	not yet probed
National artificial intelligence policy or strategy	A policy, strategy, readiness assessment or ministerial statement on artificial intelligence. The only material bearing on The Gambia in the base is a continental data-protection roundup.	not yet probed
Indian digital cooperation with The Gambia	A bilateral memorandum, a line of credit, or an India Stack or technical cooperation programme document naming The Gambia.	not yet probed
Gulf state digital investment in The Gambia	An investment agreement, data-centre or connectivity commitment from a Gulf sovereign fund or operator.	not yet probed
Domestic budget appropriations for the digital sector	An appropriation act, budget speech or estimate showing the votes for the communications ministry, the regulator and the digital programme.	not yet probed
Affordability of internet access	A domestic price basket, an affordability survey, or a regulator tariff series. Penetration is held only from a commercial reference compilation.	not yet probed

These rows carry no reliable position at either end of the period, so no movement can be stated for them. They are not evenly distributed: the largest concentration is around the two new data centres, where the base holds nothing on power, nothing on the technical capacity that runs them and nothing on any body responsible for their security.

The second concentration is fiscal. A year in which the state's central claim for digitalisation is a revenue claim is also a year in which no appropriation line for the digital programme appears anywhere in the base, and no domestic measure of what access costs a household has been published at either end.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-08-18
CURRENT EDITION	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/GMB/GMB-progress.html
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/GMB/GMB-progress-2026-08-18.pdf
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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.